



Stability matters: India's recent ODI success stems from a stable batting core, with Shreyas Iyer and KL Rahul forming the core. **AP Right:** Varun Chakaravarthy's last-minute inclusion in the squad was an inspired decision.

PTI

The high-quality spin attack choked opposition batters during the middle overs, restricting them to modest scores before India's batting prowess took centre stage. The spinners bowled 163.3 overs and accounted for 26 of the 47 wickets taken by the team, at an impressive economy rate of 4.5.

On the batting front, Shubman Gill stroked a fine century against Bangladesh, while Virat Kohli reinforced his credentials as the 'chase master' by batting through to script two memorable wins. Against Pakistan, Kohli scored an unbeaten century and then top-scored with a composed 84 in the semifinal against Australia.

The former India skipper worked hard on his game against spin,



spending extra hours in the nets before the Pakistan clash. His incredible fitness levels allowed him to run hard between the wickets without taking risks against the slower bowlers.

His efforts were backed up by Shreyas Iyer and K.L. Rahul, two batters who flew under the radar but made telling impacts. Both had a point to prove, even if they never should have been put in a position that required them to do so.

Shreyas, who was not a guaranteed starter, reeled in scores of 56, 79, 45 and 48 in the last four games, with those knocks coming under pressure when the game was delicately poised. His ability to attack spinners and find crucial boundaries during the middle phase was key to India making chases look easy.

Similarly, Rahul, pushed down a spot to number six, showed great adaptability to play big shots early in his innings, releasing the pressure immediately after the fall of a wicket.

More importantly, he was